Bugs represent inconsistencies in your software. Different teams will have different definitions of what a bug is, ranging from a variation from your application's spec to unexpected behaviors that get noticed after development is complete.

Bugs will pop up at different times depending on how your team works together. For example, a team with embedded quality engineers may not generate bugs before a feature is complete because they're working side by side with feature engineers and they work out potential problems before they're published. A team with an offshore QA team will end up generating tickets for bugs because testing is staggered with feature development.

Figure 3.5 shows two different charts that track bugs over time. Because bugs represent things you don't want your software to do, teams strive for low bug counts as an indicator of good software quality.

Figure 3.5. Two charts showing bug counts and at what point they were found